

and formatting partitions scares you, but you still want to try out Linux, a Live CD is the way to go. Some popular versions are DSL (Damn Small Linux), SUSE Live-Eval, and Knoppix.

When you need to get back to Windows, just boot from the hard disk instead of the CD, and your familiar Windows comes right back. If you are impressed by the sample of Linux on the Live CD, you can venture out and download or buy a full-blown version and install it. Mind you, the Live CD cannot offer all the features of the full version, but it is still a great way to start.

Windows and Linux have always been thought of as the North Pole and the South Pole of the computing world. But guess what—they just shrunk the world! Attempts have been made to be able to run Windows programs on Linux. This, basically, is meant to enable easier migration from Windows to Linux, and cater to the principal reason many give for staying with Windows—"What about my applications?"



Linspire (earlier called Lindows until Microsoft sued them for the name) was the first to attempt this. Microsoft Office 97 and 2000 could be run from Linux via an application called Crossover Office. Later on, Xandros and SUSE, too, could open *some* Windows applications.

Armed with this background, you are now ready to proceed to take your first steps into the world of Linux. The installation procedure follows in the next chapter.